DAY 5 | EXCEL

My Data Analyst Journey

F4, RANK & Text Formulas

Day 5 of learning Excel in public.

F4 Ctrl E &

Swipe to learn with me >

F4 Toggle

Cycle through locked references

1st press	$G$3 both locked
2nd press	G$3 row locked
3rd press	$G3 column locked
4th press	G3 back to relative

Click on the reference inside the formula, then press F4. On many laptops use Fn + F4.

RANK Function

Find a position in a list

The Idea

RANK checks one person's marks against everyone else's to find their position.

Example

A 50% = 3rd, B 60% = 2nd, C 45% = 4th, D 75% = 1st.

Formula

=RANK(F5,$F$5:$F$19). F5 is the person. $F$5:$F$19 is the whole list.

Lock the List

F5 stays relative and moves down. The range must be absolute ($) so the list never shifts.

RANK Options

Order and ties

`=RANK(F5,$F$5:$F$19)` — **Highest = Rank 1**

`=RANK(F5,$F$5:$F$19,1)` — **Lowest = Rank 1**

`=RANK.EQ(F5,$F$5:$F$19)` — **Same as RANK**

Ties share a rank. Two people tied at Rank 9 means the next person gets Rank 11 (10 is skipped). Third argument: 0 or blank = largest first, 1 = smallest first.

Text Formula Rules

Quotes or no quotes?

Numbers

Type directly, no quotes. Example: 100

Cell References

Type directly, no quotes. Example: A1

Text

Must be inside double quotes. Example: "Oneeb"

Wrap Text Off

Ctrl+1 > Alignment tab > untick Wrap text.

LEFT, RIGHT, MID

Pull text out of text

```
=LEFT(A1,3)
```
Mr.

```
=RIGHT(A2,4)
```
Arif

```
=MID(A3,5,5)
```
Oneeb

```
=RIGHT("Oneeb Arif",2)
```
if

```
=MID("Excel",2,3)
```
xce

Example name: Mr. Oneeb Arif. MID needs three things: text, start position, number of characters.

LEN, TRIM & Case

Measure and clean text

`=LEN("Oneeb")`	5
`=TRIM(" Hello ")`	Hello
`=UPPER("abcd")`	ABCD
`=LOWER("ABCD")`	abcd
`=PROPER("oneeb arif")`	Oneeb Arif

TRIM removes extra spaces at the start, at the end and between words.
LEN counts spaces too, so it is great for checking phone numbers and IDs.

Join Text

Four ways to combine

`=CONCATENATE(A1," ",B1)`	Oneeb Arif
`=CONCAT(A1,"-",B1)`	Oneeb-Arif
`=TEXTJOIN(" ",TRUE,A1,B1)`	Oneeb Arif
`=A1&" "&B1`	Oneeb Arif

Excel adds no space by itself. Put " " in the middle. The character between joined text is called the delimiter (like - or a space).

TEXTJOIN Explained

=TEXTJOIN(delimiter, ignore_empty, text1, ...)

Delimiter

The separator between each piece, like " " or "-" or ",".

TRUE

Skips empty cells. No middle name means no extra space.

FALSE

Keeps empty cells, so you get an extra space or separator.

Bonus

CONCAT and TEXTJOIN also accept a whole range, like A1:C1.

Flash Fill & Text Tools

Shortcuts for messy text

Flash Fill	Ctrl + E
Text to Columns	Alt + A + E
New line inside a cell	Alt + Enter
Format Cells box	Ctrl + 1
Expand formula bar	Ctrl + Shift + U

Flash Fill: type the first result (Oneeb Arif), press Enter, then Ctrl+E. It copies your pattern but does not update if the data changes.

Split Text

Microsoft 365 functions

```
=TEXTSPLIT(A1," ")
```

Oneeb | Arif

```
=TEXTBEFORE(A1," ")
```

Oneeb

```
=TEXTAFTER(A1," ")
```

Arif

These work in Microsoft 365 and newer Excel versions only, and TEXTSPLIT spills into the cells next to it. In older Excel use Text to Columns (Alt+A+E) or Flash Fill.

FIND vs SEARCH

Where is the character?

```
=FIND("A","EIM-4532-ABC")
```

10

```
=FIND("a","Oneeb arif")
```

7

```
=SEARCH("A","Oneeb arif")
```

7

```
=FIND("A","Oneeb arif")
```

#VALUE!

FIND is case-sensitive. SEARCH ignores case and allows wildcards. Both give the position of the first match, and #VALUE! if nothing is found.

REPLACE vs SUBSTITUTE

Position or text?

```
=REPLACE(H77,5,4,2026)
```

AXP-2026-MNO

```
=SUBSTITUTE(B77,"-","@")
```

AXP@7842@MNO

```
=SUBSTITUTE(B77,"-","@",1)
```

AXP@7842-MNO

```
=SUBSTITUTE(B77,"-","@",2)
```

AXP-7842@MNO

ID = AXP-7842-MNO. REPLACE works by position (start 5, 4 characters). SUBSTITUTE works by text, and the last number picks which match to change.

TEXT Function

Show numbers and dates your way

`=TEXT(B92,"DDDD")`	Wednesday
`=TEXT(B92,"DD DDD")`	14 Wed
`=TEXT(B92,"MMMM")`	October
`=TEXT(1234.5,"#,##0.00")`	1,234.50
`=TEXT(0.45,"0%")`	45%

B92 = 10/14/2026. The format code goes inside quotes. The result is text, not a number.

VALUE, CLEAN, CHAR, REPT

Handy utility functions

`=VALUE(B44)`	Text to number
`=CLEAN(B45)`	OneebArif
`=CHAR(65)`	A
`=CODE("A")`	65
`=REPT("*",5)`	*****

VALUE turns left-aligned text into a right-aligned number. CLEAN removes line breaks (Alt+Enter) but joins the words. To keep a space use =SUBSTITUTE(B45,CHAR(10)," ").

Text Cheat Sheet

All 20 functions in one place

Extract

LEFT, RIGHT, MID

Measure & Clean

LEN, TRIM, CLEAN

Change Case

UPPER, LOWER, PROPER

Join

CONCAT, CONCATENATE, TEXTJOIN, &

Find & Replace

FIND, SEARCH, REPLACE, SUBSTITUTE

Convert & Repeat

VALUE, TEXT, CHAR, REPT

Day 5
Done!

F4, RANK and 20 text formulas.

Which text function will you use the most?
Tell me in the comments.

Follow for Day 6

Like | Save | Repost to help another beginner